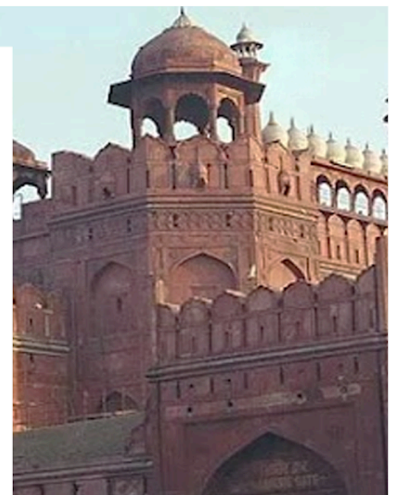
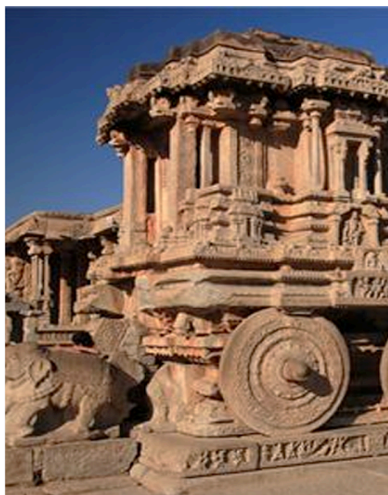


General Knowledge

Medieval History

STUDY NOTES

**RAJPUT RULERS - TOMARAS, CHAUHANAS &
GAHADAVALAS**



RAJPUT RULERS - TOMARAS, CHAUHANAS & GAHADAVALAS

Tomar Dynasty: The Tomars of Delhi

- The **Tomars** formed a **sovereign territory around Dhillika (Delhi)**, likely in the **10th century CE**.
- Their territory extended between **Delhi and Hansi (Anshika)**.
- **Anangpal Tomar (1051–1081)** was the most prominent ruler of the dynasty.

Achievements of Anangpal Tomar

- He might have received **help from Paramara King Bhoja** in driving out **Ghaznavid Governors** from **Anshika (Hansi)**.
- He built **Fort Lal Kot** in **Dhillika (Delhi)** and **Fort Aligarh** in **Anshika (Hansi)**.
- **Fort Asigarh** in Hansi became a **manufacturing hub for high-quality swords** in India.

Conflict with the Chahmanas (Chauhans)

- Several **Chahmana inscriptions** mention their **fierce battles with the Tomars**.
- **Lal Kot in Delhi** was attacked and captured multiple times by the **Chahmanas**.
- In **1152**, a **Chahmana invasion led by Vграhrajа** annexed the **Tomar territory**.



Fort Lal Kot, Delhi, 11 century

Sources on the Tomar Dynasty

- Reconstructing the history of the Tomars is challenging, as it relies on **indirect sources** from other rulers.
- The main sources include:
 1. **Gwalior manuscript** by Khadag Rai
 2. **Ain-e-Akbari** by Abul Fazl
 3. **Kumaon manuscript**

Chauhan Dynasty: The Chauhans/Chahmanas of Ajmer

- The **Chauhans of Shakambari (Sambhar)** initially served as **feudatories of the Gurjara-Pratiharas**.
- **Durlabha Chauhan** was a commander in the **Pratiharas king Vatsaraja's** campaign during the **Tripartite struggle for Kannauj**.
- The **Chauhans rose to power** after the decline of the **Gurjara-Pratiharas**.

Independent Rule of the Chauhan Dynasty

- In the **mid-10th century**, **Lakshmana Chauhan** established a branch at **Nadulla (Nadol)**.
- His elder brother **Simharaja (944–971 CE)** declared independence and took the title **Maharajadhiraja**.
- **Ajayaraja (1110–1135 CE)** founded the city of **Ajayameru (modern Ajmer)** as the **political centre and seat of power**.
- By **1150–1164 CE**, the **Tomar territory was annexed by the Chauhans** under **Vigraharaj Chauhan**.

Conflict with the Solankis (Chaulukyas)

- Initially, both **Solankis and Chauhans** faced a common threat from the **Parmaras**.
- After the fall of the Parmaras, they entered into **fierce conflicts**.
- The **Chauhans of Nadol** became **feudatories of the Solankis**.
- Peace attempts were made, with **Jaisimha Solanki** marrying his daughter to the **Chauhan King Arnoraj**.

- A peace treaty between Solankis and Chauhans was likely established in the 1180s.

Prithviraj Chauhan (Rai Pithora)

- **Prithviraj III** became the most famous Chauhan king.
- He ascended the throne at **age eleven (c. 1177 CE)** and took full control by **age sixteen**.
- He expanded his kingdom, bringing **smaller Rajput states** under his control.
- **First Battle of Tarain (1191 CE)**: Prithviraj defeated **Muhammad Gori**.
- **Second Battle of Tarain (1192 CE)**: Muhammad Gori invaded again and **defeated Prithviraj**, leading to **Prithviraj's capture or death** (sources conflict on this point).



Reasons for the Fall of the Chauhan Dynasty

- **Fatricidal Wars:**
 - Prithviraj Chauhan launched **expeditions against the Chandellas** at Mahoba, where the **warriors Alha and Udal** were killed.
 - The **Gahadavalas, Chalukyas (Solankis), and Chandellas** were also rivals of the Chauhans.

- **Division within the Clan:**
 - Some branches, like the **Chauhans of Nadol**, remained **feudatories of the Solankis** for a long period.
- **Muhammad Ghori's Invasion:**
 - Prithviraj's defeat in the **Second Battle of Tarain (1192 CE)** marked the **decline of the Chauhan dynasty**.

Literary Sources on Prithviraj Chauhan

- **"Prithviraj Vijaya":**
 - A **Sanskrit poem** by **Jayanaka**, possibly a Kashmiri Brahmin, written in praise of Prithviraj.
 - It provides a **complete lineage of the Chauhan dynasty** and details about the **First Battle of Tarain**.
 - The poem abruptly ends without covering the **Second Battle of Tarain**.
 - Its accuracy is supported by **Chahman inscriptions**.
- **"Prithviraj Raso":**
 - Written by **Chand Bardai** in **Apabhramsa** language, likely much later than the events it describes.
 - It presents a conflicting account, suggesting that **Jaichand of the Gahadavalas** invited **Muhammad Ghori** due to personal rivalry with Prithviraj.
 - However, no **inscriptions from the Gahadavalas or Chauhans** support this claim.

The Gahadavalas of Kannauj

- The **Gahadavalas** occupied **Kannauj** in the **11th century** and ruled over major parts of the **Gangetic Doab** from **1090 to 1193 CE**.
- They **governed Kannauj and Varanasi** during their rule.
- The origin of the **Gahadavalas** is not well-documented.

Independent Rule of the Gahadavalas

Ruler	Period	Achievements
Chandradeva	1089–1103 CE	- Established the Gahadaval power in Kannauj after the end of the Pratihara rule. - Captured Banaras and made it his second capital. - Stabilized the middle Ganga plain after the fall of Parmara King Bhoja and Kalachuri King Lakshmikarna.
Madanapala	1104–1113 CE	- Defended his territory against the Ghaznavid ruler Masud III, who had declared a holy war to capture the Doab region. - His son, Prince Govind Chandra, played a major role in the campaigns.
Govind Chandra	1114–1155 CE	- Under his reign, the Gahadaval kingdom expanded from Mongyr (Bihar) to Delhi. - He brought the Gahadaval power to its peak.

Decline of the Gahadavala Dynasty

Ruler	Period	Events Leading to the Fall
Jai Chandra	1170–1193 CE	- Last prominent ruler of the Gahadaval dynasty. - According to Ibn Athir's Kamil ut Tawarikh, he ruled the largest empire among the Rajputs at the time. - Although Prithviraj Raso mentions his conflict with Prithviraj Chauhan, no inscriptions from the Gahadavalas or neighbouring Rajputs confirm this. - He lost his life fighting the Ghurids in 1193 CE.
Harishchandra	Died in 1197 CE	- Continued to control Kannauj and Varanasi after the death of his father, Jai Chandra.

		- Assumed the sovereign titles Maharajadhiraja, Parameshwar, and Parambhattaraka , as recorded in the Kotwa inscription .
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Kannauj was captured by **Iltutmish** during his reign. Iltutmish celebrated this victory by **issuing coins** commemorating the conquest. Although the **Rajput kings continued to rule** in their **city-states** as **feudal lords**, their **power declined significantly** after the **Ghurid invasion of India**.